



The Streak That Isn't

Fortnightly Confidence Against a Roster That Breaks Its Own Bonus

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The problem

The Library's semester consistency bonus rewards shelving casuals for an unbroken run of rostered fortnights. Little is known about whether shelvers' own sense of being on track keeps pace with the roster system that most often breaks that run.

What we set out to test

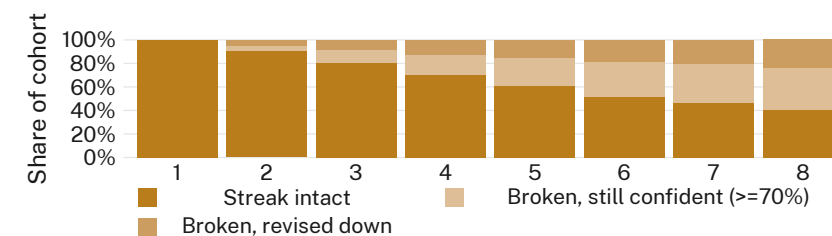
- Track shelvers' self-rated odds of reaching the bonus, fortnight by fortnight
- Match self-rated odds against each shelver's actual streak status in the roster log
- Locate how far behind a streak break confidence typically lags

Study design

- $n = 46$ rostered shelving casuals, 6 branches · fortnightly single-item odds estimate (0-100%) · 8 fortnights, one teaching period
- Streak status matched by staff ID to the roster system's own shift-continuity log
- Bonus threshold and streak-break rule held constant; no manual roster override recorded

What we found

Self-rated odds of 70% or higher held among a rising share of shelvers whose own roster log already showed a broken streak — 4% of the cohort in fortnight 2, 29% by fortnight 6. Self-rated and logged status agree less as the semester runs on ($r = 0.34$, full panel).



By fortnight 6, 29% of the cohort ($n = 13$) held a broken streak but still rated their bonus odds at 70% or higher, up from 4% ($n = 2$) in fortnight 2.

Implications & conclusions

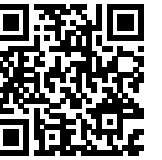
A streak break is logged the same week the roster schedules around it, with no shelver-facing notice. Confidence revises down only once someone checks their own record, which most don't until late in the period. Next: test whether a fortnightly streak-status prompt closes the gap, or just moves where confidence collapses.

Selected references

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De-identified survey responses only; no shift records retained beyond the teaching period.

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“Confidence didn't check the roster.”

29% of shelvers held a broken streak and still rated their bonus odds at 70% or higher by fortnight 6.